

THE SIEGE WITHIN



LANGUAGE BAR: Agitating students swear by English

THE HINDU

<< REWIND

Anti-Hindi protests gripped Tamil Nadu as the DMK organised the Madras State Anti-Hindi Conference on January 17, calling for observing January 26 as a day of national mourning—the day the 15-year grace period for the use of English as the official language was going to end. The stir was led by students, who hit the streets out of concern for their careers, with a call of “Hindi never, English ever”. The agitation soon became state-wide. In the Budget session of Parliament, President Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan assured members that English would stay in India. Linguistic pride had won.

BORDER CONTROL

Till 1965, Indo-Pak borders were manned by the State Armed Police Battalion. After the war, a specialised Border Security Force was formed for the international border.

FIRST CUT

The annual national beauty pageant, Femina Miss India, was held for the first time, in which Persis Khambatta was declared the winner. She went to Hollywood and later appeared in *Star Trek*.



<< DID YOU KNOW

The Army was called to patrol the streets when 1,00,000 marchers set the security booth of All India Radio and Congress president K. Kamaraj's house on fire to protest cow slaughter.